

Crystal E. Mercado Ortiz

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Professional Summary

Senior cybersecurity student with CompTIA Security+ certification, seeking an internship opportunity to enhance knowledge in network security and risk management. Passionate about leadership, staying current with cybersecurity trends, and committed to enhancing organizational security measures..

Skills

- Team Leadership & Project Coordination
- Proficient in: C++, Python
- Scripting: Bash, Batch
- Network Configuration & Troubleshooting
- TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, VLANs, and Routing Protocols
- SIEM: Splunk, Microsoft Defender
- Log Analysis & Threat Detection
- Incident Response Support

Work History

Team Advisor/Head Team Advisor, 07/2024 — 07/2026

National Student Leadership Conference — Baltimore, MD

- Designed and facilitated workshops covering topics such as penetration testing methodologies, network analysis with Wireshark, cryptography fundamentals, and digital forensics using Autopsy, providing students with experiential learning aligned to collegiate-level content.
- Served as a technical mentor and team lead for a multidisciplinary staff cohort, including Team Advisors and support staff, offering ongoing guidance on instructional delivery, classroom facilitation, and conflict resolution within a fast-paced, immersive learning environment.

Cyber Ops Intern, 09/2023 — 12/2023

LUMA

- Developed an automated script using TCP Dump to capture 12 hours of network traffic, streamlining the data collection process, and established guidelines for threat hunting procedures that are now actively utilized by the company with the ACHunter platform to detect Command and Control (C2) traffic.
- Led a team project to conceptualize an innovative peer-to-peer omnidirectional energy trading application, enhancing the company's approach to energy distribution.

Research Intern, 05/2023 — 08/2023

Air Force Research Laboratory

- Team led a group of Interns in project that aims to use Natural Language Processing Algorithms for Network Intrusion Detection.
- Applied the principals of a Genetic Algorithm to optimize Data Tokenization to create a balanced vocabulary for the Word2Vec NLP algorithm.

Education

Expected in 05/2026 Universidad Inter Americana De Puerto Rico — Bayamón

Bachelor of Science Cybersecurity

- Currently serving as a Vocal Member of the Directive Board for the InfoTech Association at Inter American University of Puerto Rico, Bayamón (IAUPR).
- Received special recognition from Inter American University for outstanding contributions to internships.
- Organized and conducted a Linux 101 and Capture the Flag (CTF) workshop for members of the InfoTech Association, enhancing their technical skills and knowledge.

Certifications

- Certified CompTIA Security+